"MORE THAN WORDS": GENRE-DISCRIMINATING LYRICAL PATTERNS IN ANGLOPHONE GERMAN POPULAR MUSIC

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ABSTRACT

Recent advances in natural language processing have improved lyrics-based music genre classification through large language models, yet such black box systems obscure the actual linguistic style differences between music genres. Interpretable approaches in computational musicology and MIR, meanwhile, often relied on either formal structural analysis of lyrics or on topic or sentiment analyses. However, genre-typical formulaic expressions, though deemed relevant in popular music studies, have hardly been investigated at all. Our study contributes to filling this gap by uncovering genre discriminative lyrical style patterns—topics, sentiments, and formulaic expressions—in fifty years of Anglophone German popular music. Using the POPTRAG corpus and *Discogs* genre annotations for 126,042 tracks with English lyrics, we apply the fightin' words method to identify statistically distinctive n-grams across genres. We then identify latent topics, sentiments, and types of formulaic expression from these via structural topic modeling using target genre corpus prevalences as priors. Resulting interpretable lyrics features are employed in machine-learning models that reveal how they function as stylistic markers for specific popular music genres. Our transparent ML approach retains roughly 80% of the predictive performance of a transfer-learned DistilBERT classifier while offering conceptual insight into how lyrics encode genre identity.

1. INTRODUCTION

Popular music does not resonate with audiences through sound alone. Lyrics shape emotional interpretation, social meaning, and collective memory [1,2], making them a central component of the listening experience and a rich object of study for Computational Musicology (CM) and Music Information Retrieval (MIR) [3]. Because lyrics are textual material, they allow large-scale analysis across songs and genres, complementing audio-based approaches with an explicit linguistic perspective on popular music. This makes them especially useful for studying music genre differences, since genres organize songs through recurring stylistic markers and socio-cultural conventions [4], many of which are encoded in lyrics [5–9]. To this end, lyrics-based genre recognition can serve as a research tool for popular music studies: by predicting genre from textual features, it can uncover which lyrical patterns most strongly differentiate genres and how these patterns vary across the popular music landscape [10, 11].

Recent research at the intersection of MIR and Natural Language Processing (NLP) has leveraged deep learning architectures and word embeddings to employ lyrics for genre classification [10, 12–14]. Pretrained LLM models, such as BERT [15] and its derivativeRoBERTa [16] and DistilBERT [17] have become widely used in NLP classification tasks, offering strong predictive performance but limited transparency [18]. Their embeddings compress complex semantic and syntactic information into high-dimensional spaces whose dimensions lack human-interpretable meaning. Consequently, while such models excel at prediction, they provide little understanding of how linguistic patterns shape genre distinctions. While there exist approaches to trace black box model decisions back to individual humam-readable token through attention visualisation [10, 19], they do not mitigate semantic bias during embedding of tokens [20, 21] and insights remain at the sparse representation level of individual tokens. This interpretability gap limits both scholarly attempts to connect lyrical style with musical culture and applied uses of lyrics-based classifiers, where understanding model behavior is essential for debugging, bias detection, and trustworthy deployment [22, 23].

Conversely, interpretable approaches to lyrics-based music genre analysis in CM and MIR have so far emphasized stylistic features that relate to formal or structural aspects of lyrics, such as rhyme features, repetition features (e.g., repeated line ratio, echoisms), textual statistics (e.g., word count, POS-tag frequencies) or lexical descriptors (e.g., complexity, readability, type-token ratio, slang frequency, metaphor density) [8, 20, 24, 25]. While such features can capture important stylistic tendencies, they might fail to fully capture genre identity that is also shaped by patterns of certain topics, sentiments and linguistic formulas typical for the music producing scenes [2]. Together these aspects are called *lyrical style* [26].

In this contribution, we conceptualize style-related genre-discriminating lyrical patterns as recurrent linguistic structures that are strongly associated with specific genres

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and that relate to the meaning of lyrics. These include topics (What are the lyrics about?, e.g., love, doubt, drugs), sentiments (With what affect do lyrics talk about something?, e.g., romantic, apocalyptic, affirmative), and formulaic expressions (genre-specific slang, typical collocations, and vocalizations; e.g., "jah", "get down on it", "oh la la"). Notably, we understand formulaic expressions as a broad category that not only includes multi-word expressions like commonly-used collocations and idioms [27,28], but also single words that show formulaic usage in music lyrics and function as style markers, such as slang words or words with spelling variations [25, 26], highly common words that appear as lexical rather tan topical [25], and single-word vocalizations [29].

Some popular music scholars have already attempted to capture stylistic patterns in large song lyrics corpora through topic modeling [30] or sentiment analysis [31]; [32] have investigated the use of formulas in blues lyrics, and [28] have developed an automatic classifier for multi-word idioms in German popular music lyrics. However, to our knowledge so far no study has systematically identified and analyzed genre-discriminating stylistic patterns using machine learning models. To this end, n-gram-based models—despite their conceptual simplicity-directly reflect the recurrent lexical patterns that linguists identify as characteristic of popular song language [33]. At the same time, n-gram-based features have performed quite well in comparison to more sophisticated hand-crafted style features in lyrics-based genre classification [24, 25].

Summing up, this study advances lyrics-based MIR by revisiting the n-gram paradigm through an interpretable machine learning lens. We examine a culturally-bounded large corpus of Anglophone popular songs frequently listened to in Germany to identify content-related, genre-discriminative lyrical patterns including topics, sentiments, and formulaic expressions. In doing so, we test whether pattern-based interpretable models can approximate the predictive power of a fine-tuned transformer baseline while providing substantive interpretive value for popular-music research. Specifically, this paper adresses the following research questions:

RQ1 Which content-related genre-discriminative lyrical style patterns (topics, sentiments, formulaic expressions) exist in Anglophone German popular music?

RQ2 To what extent do style pattern-based interpretable ML models match a fine-tuned DistilBERT LLM baseline on lyrics-based popular music genre prediction?

RQ3 What can we learn about style-related lyrical genre differences from such interpretative models for popular music studies?

2. METHODS

Please refer to Figure 1 for an overview of the method flow. All operations that involved randomness were seeded with 42 for reproducibility; code and data (except for the copyrighted lyrics) will be made publicly available in the camera-ready version.

2.1 Corpus and Genre Annotations

We based our analysis on a previously collected corpus of 254,334 unique popular tracks frequently listened to in Germany over the past 50 years (POPTRAG). The corpus combines multiple sources: (1) 215,702 tracks from weekly *MediaControl* German single and album charts, capturing the 100 most relevant albums and songs per week by physical/digital sales, streams, and broadcasts (18 Nov 1977-21 Nov 2024; limited to 75% of tracks successfully linked to *Spotify* identifiers for consistent metadata); (2) 11,994 unique track entries from Germany's *Daily Top 200 Spotify* charts (Jan 2017–Nov 2024). To capture not only music sales but also listened-to music no longer in the charts, the corpus additionally includes (3) 26,949 *Spotify* track recommendations from 126 German-market genre seeds (retrieved 29 Nov 2024; median 325 per seed, IQR 25, range 49-343); and (4) 8,801 tracks from the 100 top-featured *Spotify* playlists for Germany (retrieved 29 Nov 2024, median 90 tracks per playlist, IQR 42, range 28-750). 853 tracks shorter than 30 seconds were excluded and only unique title-artist combinations were retained, selecting earlier release dates for duplicates.

Using data linkage and webscraping, we enriched POPTRAG with lyrics from *Genius* [1] and release music genre annotations from *Discogs* [2]. We focused our analysis tracks with retrieved English lyrics and at least one *Discogs* music genre annotation (51%). 35% of the remaining tracks were assinged more than one genre by the *Discogs* community. For them, we retained only the most specific genre label (i.e., the one that appeared least frequently in the corpus) to enable an easily interpretable single-label classification task. Finally, we removed genres that made up less than 1% of the remaining corpus, resulting in a final sample of N=126,042 tracks across 9 genres (see Figure 2 for details on the corpus composition).

2.2 RQ1: Music Genre Discriminating Vocabularies

To identify genre-discriminating lyrical style patterns (RQ1), we first performed basic cleaning on raw lyrics from *Genius*: trimming whitespaces, removing content within square brackets, normalizing asterisks, removing repetition and song position indicators, and fixing missing apostrophes (e.g., "don t" → "don't").

To extract relevant n-grams for each lyrical style pattern dimension (topics, sentiments, formulaic expressions), we applied dimension-specific preprocessing steps. For topics and sentiments, we expanded contractions (e.g., "don t" → "do not"), lemmatized and POS-tagged lyrics using *spaCy's* `en_core_web_lg` model with a custom domain lexicon, then reduced to nouns (topics) or adjectives and adverbs (sentiments). We retained only tokens with more than two characters present in both the `en_core_web_lg` vocabulary and the English *nltk* li-

[1] https://genius.com
[2] https://discogs.com

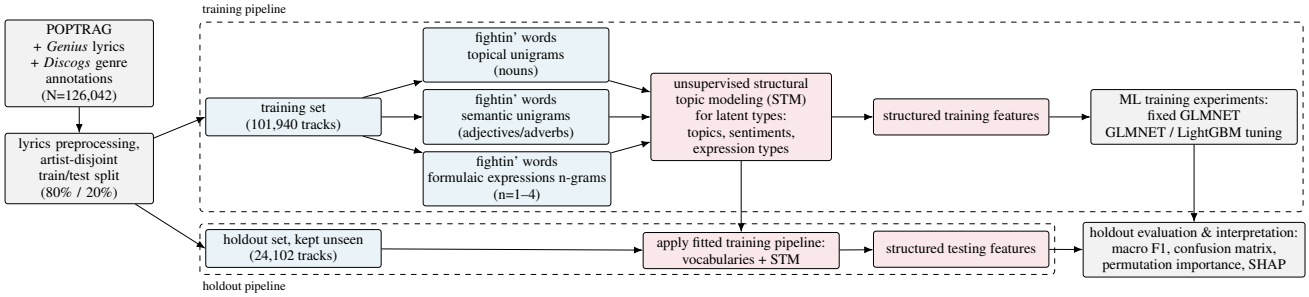


Figure 1: Overview of the methodology. Genre-discriminative vocabularies are constructed on training data only, then integrated via STM into latent interpretable features; fitted components are applied to holdout data for final model evaluation.

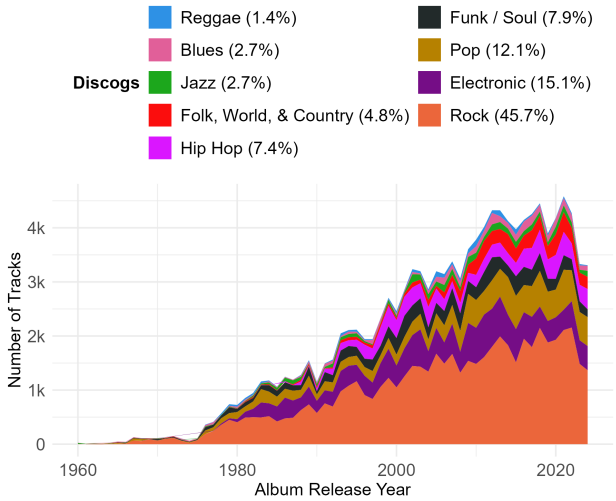


Figure 2: Composition of the analyzed corpus.

brary to exclude non-lexical items. All n-grams were converted to lowercase. We then stratified the corpus into 80% training and 20% holdout sets by genre distribution, ensuring no artist overlap to mitigate artist and album effects [34].

The following steps were applied to the training corpus only; the holdout set was used exclusively for final ML model evaluation. We constructed three separate vocabularies of genre-discriminating n-grams: unigrams for topics and sentiments, and n-grams (n=1-4) for formulaic expressions. All n-grams required appearance with more than one artist and could not consist solely of stopwords. For expressions, we additionally excluded bigrams starting with "a", "an", "the", and "to" to remove trivial noun+article and to+infinitive constructions.

We then applied the fightin' words method [35] to identify genre-discriminative n-grams. This method quantifies n-gram association with each genre via log-odds ratios—comparing relative frequency in one genre versus all others combined. To account for rare n-grams, we applied Bayesian smoothing using empirical prevalence as a Dirichlet prior. We converted log-odds ratios to z-scores (standardized test statistics indicating standard deviations from zero; larger absolute values indicate stronger discrimination) and applied a one-sided statistical t-test (upper tail) to identify significantly associated n-grams. Given thousands of simultaneous z-score computations across genres, we applied Benjamini-Hochberg false discovery rate (FDR) correction [36] at $\alpha = 0.001$, identifying the most stringent z-score threshold with at most 0.1% expected false positives. N-grams exceeding this FDR-corrected threshold with positive z-scores were retained.

2.3 RQ1: Latent Types of Discriminating Patterns

To identify genre-discriminating latent topics, sentiments, and types of formulaic expressions (RQ1), we employed structural topic modeling (STM) [37] using n-grams from the training corpus vocabularies, to cluster them into latent types discriminative for specific genres using target genres prevalences as priors. To this end, we aggregated n-gram counts on the artist level and performed stm training with these (reducing 101,940 track documents to XXX artist documents), selecting the most specific genre for artists with multiple genres. This was done to mitigate per-track n-gram sparsity during stm model training, that would lead to high variance problems and resulting overfitting in later classifier training.

We ran STM separately for topics, sentiments, and expressions, testing an interpretable range of 2 to 20 types each. For determining the number of topics, we used a train-validation split (50%/50%) and calculated semantic coherence and likelihood on the validation set as well as the exclusivity score [38] for each configuration. We chose the optimal number of types primarily based on the highest exclusivity score (measuring how uniquely top n-grams associate with single types), while maintaining good semantic coherence and validation likelihood. After selecting the optimal number of types, we reran STM on the full training corpus and interpreted types using n-grams with the highest FREX scores not contained within other high-FREX ngrams. [39], which balance frequency and exclusivity. Finally, we applied the final stm models to individual tracks to get per-track type-probabilities. Then, we calculated average per-genre probabilities for each topic, sentiment, and expression type in the training set to analyze their distributions in the training corpus.

2.4 RQ2 and RQ3: Machine Learning Experiments

To evaluate how well genre-discriminating lyrical patterns would predict music genre (RQ2), we trained machine learning models with extracted topics, sentiments, and expression type probabilities as features and with all dimensions combined. We compared performance of our final models against a random baseline, a TF-IDF [25] + GLMNET [40] pipeline, and a fine-tuned DistilBERT model [17] trained on raw lyrics. We initially trained GLMNET models with fixed hyperparameters (penalty $C = 1$, $L1$ ratio$= 0.5$) on individual and combined feature sets. In a final run we then performed systematic hyperparameter tuning for combined-features GLMNET (10×10 grid search, C logarithmic [10^{-5}, 10^{5}], $L1$ ratio [0, 1]) and also a LightGBM [41] (Tree-structured Parzen Estimator [42]: trees [100, 2000], learning rate [0.001, 0.1], leaves [20, 70], max depth [1, 10], minimum leaf data [1, 100], feature fraction [0.1, 1.0], $L1/L2$ regularization logarithmic [10^{-8}, 10.0]) using 4-fold artist-grouped stratified cross-validation. We always evaluated training performance via macro $F1$ scores from cross-validation and prediction performance using a holdout set untouched by model training or feature extraction.

To identify which stylistic patterns would actually contribute most to genre discrimination and in order to investigate interpretable genre profiles (RQ3), we computed permutation feature importance [43] on the holdout set for the best combined-features model. We also computed SHAP values [44] on the holdout set for the best-performing genre to illustrate how specific features drive predictions.

3. RESULTS

3.1 RQ1: Music Genre Discriminating Patterns

Using the fightin' words method on the train corpus, we identified genre-discriminating vocabularies: 3,831 topical nouns, 857 sentiment adjectives and adverbs, and 56,804 formulaic expressions (12% unigrams, 33% bigrams, 35% trigrams, 19% quadgrams). Using STM based on these vocabularies, we identified 10 topics, 6 sentiments, and 11 expression types, which we interpreted and labeled using n-grams with the highest FREX scores (see Table 1 for examples and supplemental material for the full list). The genre-discriminative topics were: *Americana*, *Darkness*, *Embodiment*, *Existentialism*, *Heroic Saga*, *Holidays*, *Nature*, *Narrative*, *Romance*, and *Street Life*. Sentiments were: *ambivalent*, *apocalyptic*, *brash*, *nostalgic*, *affirmative*, and *romantic*. Expression types were: *Christmas Phrases*, *Dance Floor Shoutings*, *Denials & Doubts*, *Doom Imaginary*, *Jamaican Patois*, *Landscape Imaginary*, *Love Affirmations*, *Blues & Rock Idioms*, *Hip Hop & Street Slang*, *Trap Slang*, and *Vocalizations*.

Per-genre probability distributions of types (see Figure 3) for topics and sentiments show similar distributions with minor variation across genres, though sentiment probabilities are more evenly distributed while topic probabilities concentrate in specific genres. Notably, *Hip Hop* shows distinctively high probability for *Street Life* (41%) and the *brash* sentiment (28%), but comparatively low probabilities for *Existentialism* (13%), *Nature* (4%), *Romance* (6%), and *romantic* sentiment (16%). Similarly, *Rock* exhibits elevated probabilities for *Darkness* (11%), *Heroic Saga* (10%), and *apocalyptic* sentiment (18%). *Existentialism* generally appears consistently (>20%) across nearly all genres. Expression type distributions are more heterogeneous and concentrated than topics and sentiments. Genre-specific concentrations appear for *Hip Hop & Street Slang* (39%) and *Trap Slang* (23%) in *Hip Hop*, *Jamaican Patois* in *Reggae* (33%), *Doom Imaginary* in *Rock* (27%), and *Christmas Phrases* in *Jazz* (21%). In contrast, *Denials & Doubts*, *Landscape Imaginary*, and *Love Affirmations* distribute more evenly across genres.

3.2 RQ2: Interpretable ML Performance

Using genre-discriminative topics, sentiments, and expression types as lyrical style features, we trained GLMNET and LightGBM models to predict song genre, comparing performance against a random baseline, TF-IDF + GLMNET, and a fine-tuned DistillBERT model on raw lyrics (Table 2). Our structured representations yielded informative genre signal compared to the random baseline (holdout $F1$=0.111) and uninformed TF-IDF+GLMNET (0.248) pipeline. Among structured features, expressions proved most discriminative (0.282), followed by topics (0.229) and sentiments (0.135). Combined features with GLMNET (C=1, $L1$=0.5) achieved macro $F1$ 0.292 on the holdout, exceeding individual feature sets. Hyperparameter tuning improved performance further. A regularized GLMNET (C =0.002, $L1$=0.33) achieved 0.335 in cross-validation and 0.291 on the holdout set, while the tuned LightGBM performed best among structured approaches (CV 0.354, holdout 0.300). Although DistilBERT remained strongest overall, the tuned LightGBM retained approximately 80% of its predictive power while offering interpretable features and feature contributions.

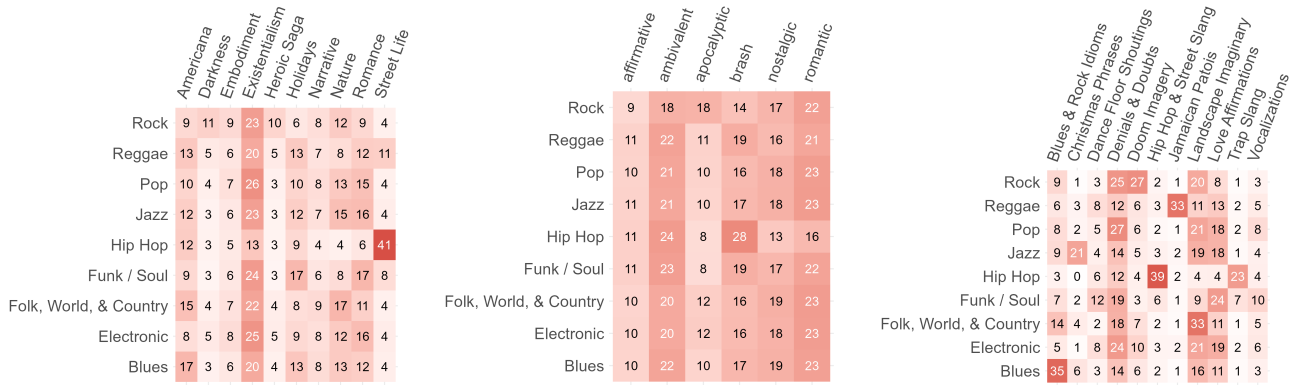
The tuned LightGBM model performs best for *Hip Hop* (holdout $F1$=0.591) and *Rock* (0.584), and worst for *Folk, World & Country* (0.177) and *Jazz* (0.137) (see Figure 4). Off-diagonal confusions cluster among stylistically adjacent categories (e.g., *Funk / Soul*, *Pop*, *Electronic*, and *Hip Hop*). Although genre prevalence in the training data shows a moderate positive relationship with classification quality (Kendall correlation = 0.389), some smaller genres like *Hip Hop* outperform larger ones like *Pop*.

3.3 RQ3: Feature Importances and SHAP Values

To assess which stylistic patterns shape music genre differentiation, we computed permutation feature importance for the LightGBM prediction on the holdout set (Figure 5). Expression-type features dominate: *Doom Imagery*, *Hip Hop & Street Slang*, *Love Affirmations*, *Blues & Rock Idioms*, *Vocalizations*, and *Dance Floor Shoutings* are the most influential predictors. Topic features such as *Darkness*, *Narrative*, and *Street Life* occupy intermediate positions, with moderate performance declines when permuted, suggesting thematic context supports but does not

Dimension	Label	Example high-FREX n-grams
Topic	Americana	beer, john, funk, monkey, whiskey, jack, cowboy, johnny, hat, lee
Topic	Darkness	chaos, death, humanity, destruction, agony, decay, hate, existence, hatred, terror
Topic	Embodiment	skin, mouth, space, hole, tongue, shape, planed, head, reflection, breath
Sentiment	ambivalent	pretty, maybe, good, nice, bad, sad, easy, glad, totally, busy
Sentiment	apocalyptic	final, evil, eternal, ancient, sacred, deadly, violent, rotten, mortal
Sentiment	brash	big, dumb, nasty, super, crazy, extra, rich, double, hot, sticky
Expression	Christmas Phrases	let it snow let, snow let it snow, it snow let it, lonley so lonly so, dreaming of a white, of a white christmas, a merry little christmas, have yourself a merry, yourself a merry little, in a winter wonderland
Expression	Dance Floor Shoutings	na na na na, doo doo doo doo, ba ba ba ba, ya ya ya ya, man man man man, li li, ma ma ma ma, move your body, put your hands up, ba dum
Expression	Denials & Doubts	in my head, i hate, it doesn't, blame, i won't, it's not, pretend, wasted, you're not, mistakes

Table 1: Example interpretations of genre-discriminative topic, sentiments, and expression types with top high-FREX n-grams.



(a) topics (b) sentiments (c) formulaic expressions

Figure 3: Latent genre-discriminative topics, sentiments, and styles: probabilities per genre in the training corpus [%].

Features	Model	Hyperparameters	$F1_{CV}$	$F1_{HO}$
Prevalences	Random	—	—	0.111
Raw Lyrics	DistillBERT	default	—	0.374
TF-IDF	GLMNET	C=1, $L1$=0.5	—	0.248
Topics	GLMNET	C=1, $L1$=0.5	—	0.229
Sentiments	GLMNET	C=1, $L1$=0.5	—	0.135
Expressions	GLMNET	C=1, $L1$=0.5	—	0.282
Combined	GLMNET	C=1, $L1$=0.5	—	0.292
Combined	GLMNET	C=0.002, $L1$=0.33	0.335	0.291
Combined	LightGBM	tuned	0.354	0.300

Table 2: Macro $F1$ evaluation for classification experiments. Values show mean $F1$ from 4-fold cross-validation (CV) and $F1$ on holdout set (HO).

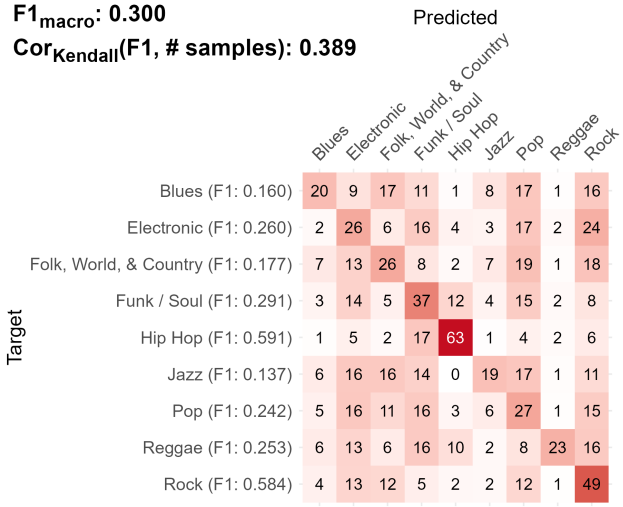


Figure 4: Confusion matrix for combined tuned lightGBM model with P(Precited|Target) [%], holdout $F1$, and correlation between per-genre $F1$ and per-genre number of samples in training set.

solely determine genre distinction. Sentiment features show only minor average impacts. The expression type *Christmas Phrases* displays increased holdout $F1$ when permuted, likely reflecting feature sparsity rather than substantive genre relevance.

As an illustrative example, Figure 6 shows SHAP values for the *Hip Hop* class (holdout $F1$=0.591). High values for *Trap Slang* and *Hip Hop & Street Slang* strongly increase predicted *Hip Hop* scores; *Street Life* and *Denials & Doubts* similarly shift predictions toward this genre. In contrast, *Christmas Phrases* and *Blues & Rock Idioms* are associated with lower *Hip Hop* likelihoods. Some features (e.g., *Doom Imaginary*, *Jamaican Patois*, and *Love Affirmations*) show context-dependent effects, sometimes increasing and sometimes decreasing *Hip Hop* predictions. Sentiment features contribute only minimally to *Hip Hop*

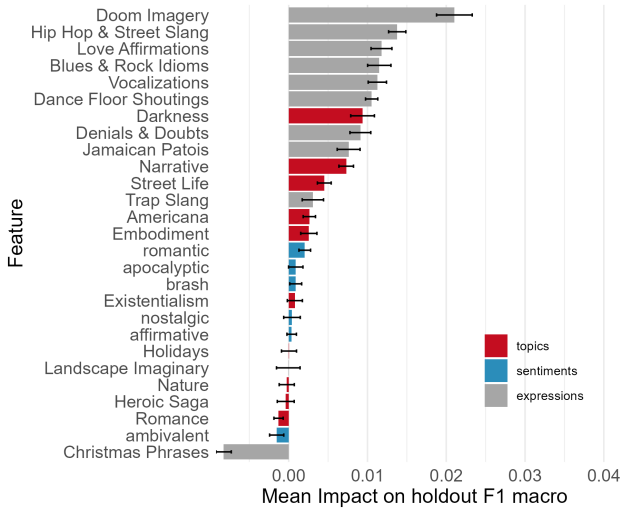


Figure 5: Permutation importance on heldout data for the tuned LightGBM model with combined features.

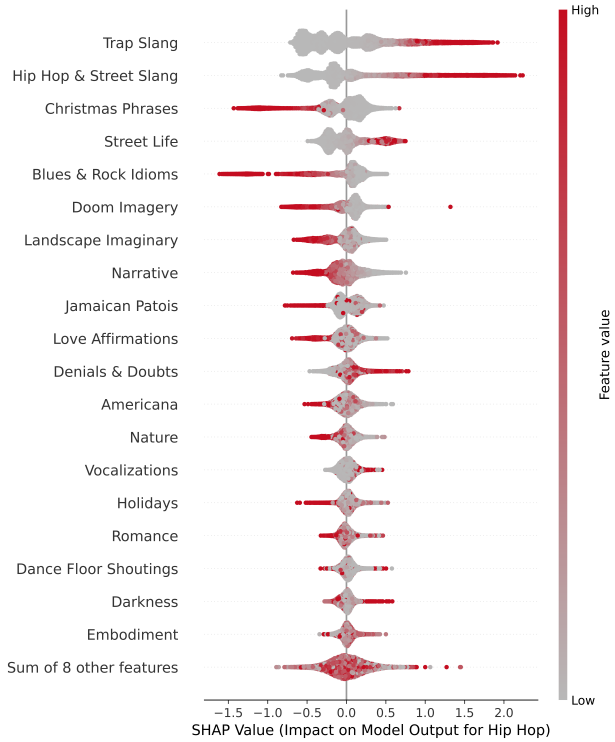


Figure 6: Example: SHAP values for *Discogs' Hip Hop* calculated from the holdout set.

identification.

4. DISCUSSION

In this contribution, we identify genre-discriminative lyrical style patterns in Anglophone popular music frequently listened to in Germany (RQ1): 10 topics, 6 sentiments, and 11 types of formulaic expressions. Interpretable ML models based on these patterns (RQ2) retain 80% of the predictive performance of a fine-tuned DistilBERT classifier, demonstrating that pattern-based features allow effective genre classification with interpretability. Feature importance analyses (RQ3) reveal that in general formulaic expressions are substantially more discriminative than topics and sentiments, which shows that this aspect has been largely underestimated in prior research. Using *Hip Hop* as an example, we show how expressions, topics, and sentiments jointly characterize the lyrical style of this genre.

In sum, lyrical genre differences are not only affecting lexical, diversity, readability, rhyme, and structural aspects [5, 8, 24, 25]. They also encompass style as represented by formulalic and topical patterns and to a lower degree also sentiments as identified in our analysis (RQ1). Formulaic expressions emerge as particularly informative for genre differentiation compared to topics and sentiment, supporting the view that genre-specific phrasing contributes substantially to how genres are lyrically defined and perceived [2].

In our interpretable ML experiments (RQ2), Hip Hop and Rock were most readily identifiable from lyrical features alone, suggesting some genres rely more strongly on distinctive lyrical style markers while others share similar markers and are therefore more easily confused. Given that *Discogs' Rock* encompasses metal styles, this finding aligns with prior lyric-based genre work [10, 25] and the view of music genre as rather fuzzy categories organized around prototypical features that not only encompass acoustical features and lyrics, but also release and artist features [4].

Our feature importance analysis (RQ3) revealed that stylistic genre differences are primarily driven by formulaic expression types like *Hip Hop & Street Slang*, *Trap Slang*, and *Doom Imagery* rather than topics or sentiments alone. The *Hip Hop* case illustrates this: street life topics and slang expressions jointly elevate predictions. Genres differ in how they package meaning through stylistic phrasing, with topical content playing a supporting role. Interestingly, although the STM was trained on artist-aggregated documents, the learned n-gram distributions capture stable stylistic regularities that generalize beyond the training level. Individual tracks' lyrics can be interpreted as very short, noisy realizations of these latent styles, allowing for meaningful posterior inference of type probabilities at the track level in our approach, as benchmarking results demonstrate.

Beyond insights into Anglophone German popular music, our findings demonstrate a principled division between predictive and explanatory ML approaches. While black-box transformers excel at predictive performance, interpretable models reveal which linguistic patterns drive predictions, enabling musicological insights for better understanding what constitutes certain genres rather than a mere optimization of correct genre tagging [18]. Such an explanatory capacity also supports practical applications: understanding genre biases in generative models that draw on lyrics [23]; corpus curation tools that flag culturally distinctive markers for ethnomusicological analyses [32]; and hybrid genre taggers for streaming platforms balancing predictive power with transparency.

Our analysis faces several limitations. First, music genres are inherently fuzzy categories [45]; by using *Discogs* labels, we adopt a particular community's perspective on genre boundaries, using other category systems could possible result in other findings. We intentionally simplified the multi-labelling of a larger number of tracks into single-label classification to enable a simpler prediction approach and better interpretability. Second, permutation feature importance can be biased when features are more strongly correlated [46]. Although some features showed substantial intercorrelations, we preserved individual linguistic pattern interpretability at the cost of potential ranking distortion. Third, our approach treats genres as stable categories while some authors have argued that their meaning might change accross time [47]. Finally, our corpus focuses on Anglophone popular music consumed in Germany, limiting generalizability to global Anglophone repertoires or non-English music popular in Germany.

Future research will extend the presented approach to other languages, comparing lyrical patterns across linguistic contexts and exploring language-agnostic interpretable models [48]. We also plan to test generalizability across diverse corpora beyond German popular music listening and incorporate additional lyrical features alongside multimodal audio characteristics [12] to build more robust interpretable genre classifiers.

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